

James Mugambi

Tax Accounting | Tax Compliance | Tax Research | Tax Advice | Tax Policy

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Profile

Senior taxation and finance executive with more than thirteen years of experience leading corporate tax compliance, tax risk management, tax policy analysis, and regulatory engagement across multiple organizations. Extensive experience advising boards and executive leadership on the tax implications of strategic decisions, business structures, contracts, and emerging legislation.

Active contributor to tax policy reforms through engagement with SMEs, Parliament, the National Treasury, and Kenya Revenue Authority.

Core Competencies

Tax Policy Analysis · Tax Research · Tax Dispute Resolution · Tax Audit · Tax Accounting · Tax Reporting · Tax Theory · International & Domestic (EAC) Tax Law · OECD-BEPS Action Points · Governance · Stakeholder Management · Team Leadership.

Leadership Achievements

- Directed tax compliance across two organizations concurrently.
- Built organizational tax capability by developing internal tax policies, compliance procedures, and technical guidance that improved consistency and reporting integrity.
- Enhanced organizational credibility through constructive engagement with KRA, auditors, and other regulatory stakeholders.
- Positioned executive leadership to make informed strategic decisions through timely tax advisory, planning models, and legislative analysis.
- Actively contributed to national tax policy development through technical submissions on Finance Bills, Tax Laws and Tax Procedures & Regulations.

Education

03/2023 – Present Nairobi, Kenya	Doctor of Philosophy in Economics <i>Moi University</i>
01/2019 – 06/2022 Nairobi, Kenya	Masters in Tax and Customs Administration (Specialized in Tax Administration) <i>Moi University</i>
08/2008 – 12/2012 Eldoret, Kenya	Bachelors in Agricultural Bio-Systems and Management (Specialized in Agri-Business) <i>Moi University</i>

Publications

12/08/2026	The Robot Tax in Sub-Saharan Africa: Concept, Context, and Viability. <i>Conference Paper presented at the 7th ICPAK Research conference, 2026</i>
10/08/2026	Deferred Until Distribution: Assessing the Viability of the Distributed Profit Tax Model for Corporate Taxation in Sub-Saharan Africa. <i>International Journal of Education, Science and Social Sciences (IJESSS)</i>

- 03/08/2026 **Human Capital Efficiency and Firm-Level Labour Productivity: Panel Evidence from Publicly Listed Firms in East Africa.**
Journal of Frontiers in Humanities and Social Sciences
- 30/07/2026 **Organizational Capital Efficiency and Labour Productivity: Evidence from publicly listed firms in East Africa.**
Journal of Business, Economics and Management Research Studies

Professional Experience

- 06/2016 – Present
 Nairobi **Head of Finance & Operations**
Yakwetu Online Limited
- Directed the company's tax compliance, overseeing corporate Income Tax, VAT, PAYE, and other tax obligations in accordance with the tax legislation.
 - Advised the Board of Directors and senior leadership on tax implications of operational decisions, contractual arrangements, and regulatory developments.
 - Interpreted provisions of the tax laws to guide the appropriate tax treatment of transactions and business activities.
 - Designed internal tax compliance procedures and documentation systems to ensure accuracy of filings and readiness for regulatory audits.
 - Represented the organization in engagements with the Kenya Revenue Authority (KRA), including audit coordination, reconciliations, and regulatory correspondence.
 - Conducted tax risk assessments across operational processes and supplier contracts, ensuring proper application of tax laws and procedures.
 - Developed internal tax computation and planning tools used in budgeting and financial planning discussions with the Board.
 - Monitored developments in international tax policy, including OECD Base Erosion and Profit Shifting (BEPS) initiatives, to anticipate regulatory implications for the company.
- 03/2015 – Present
 Nairobi **Head of Finance & Operations**
PHAT! Music & Entertainment Limited
- Managed tax compliance, including corporate income tax, VAT, PAYE, and withholding tax obligations.
 - Advised the Board of Directors on tax risks and regulatory considerations embedded in contracts, supplier relationships, and operational structures.
 - Led tax audit engagements with the Kenya Revenue Authority, coordinating regulatory responses and supporting documentation.
 - Interpreted tax legislation governing service contracts, supplier payments, and cross-border engagements, ensuring correct application of tax law provisions.
 - Designed and implemented tax control procedures within operational processes to mitigate regulatory exposure.
 - Developed internal tax policies and procedural frameworks aligned with evolving statutory requirements.
 - Ensured reconciliation between statutory tax filings and financial statements, strengthening reporting integrity.
- 02/2013 – 02/2015
 Nairobi **Finance & Administration Executive**
PHAT! Music & Entertainment Limited
- Prepared and filed VAT, PAYE, and withholding tax returns in accordance with statutory deadlines and regulatory requirements.
 - Maintained tax records and supporting documentation for statutory filings and regulatory review.
 - Reconciled tax entries in the general ledger and verified the tax treatment of supplier invoices against statutory provisions.
 - Coordinated with external tax advisors and auditors during compliance reviews and tax assessments.

- Implemented the organization's tax compliance calendar, improving planning and reducing exposure to filing penalties.
- Supported internal reviews to ensure proper application of tax law and procedures across supplier transactions.

Professional Certifications

- Certified Public Accountant of Kenya (CPA-K)

Courses

08/2026 – 08/2026	SOUTHMOD Online Training Course on tax-benefit microsimulation modelling for countries in the Global South <i>United Nations University World Institute for Development Economics Research (UNU-WIDER)</i>
09/2024 – 11/2024	Virtual PhD Course on Urban Economics <i>Bureau for Research and Economic Analysis of Development - International Growth Centre (BREAD-IGC)</i>
04/2019 – 07/2019	Unlocking Investment and Finance in Emerging Markets and Developing Economies (EMDEs) <i>World Bank Group</i>

Languages

English	Kiswahili
Fluent (Reading, Writing)	Fluent (Reading, Writing)

Affiliations

2015 – Present	Institute of Certified Public Accountants of Kenya – ICPAK Member No.: 15334
2008 – Present	Kenya Red Cross Society Life member
2006 – Present	Young Men Christian Association (YMCA - Kenya) Life member
2023 – 2025	Mandela Washington Fellowship for Young African Leaders <i>Application Reader</i>

Policy Engagement

Tax Policy Engagement

Over the years, I have actively engaged with the Kenya Parliament, the National Treasury, and the Kenya Revenue Authority on various tax law proposals, with the aim of improving the quality of legislation and ensuring alignment with global best practice and established tax principles.

Bills and regulatory proposals I have provided feedback on include:

- Finance Bills 2023 to 2026 (annual engagement).
- Tax Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2024.
- Income Tax (Domestic Minimum Top-Up Tax) Regulations, 2025.
- Income Tax (Residential Rental Income Tax) Regulations, 2026.
- OECD's Amendments to the Model Reporting Rules for Digital Platforms to Support Exchange of Tax Information, 2026.

SME Engagements

Clients: Small Scale Farms Limited, Dudu Squad Limited, Ausbridge Investments Limited, Diagrid Group Limited.

I help small and micro-enterprises manage their tax compliance. My work includes monitoring compliance levels, conducting tax risk exposure assessments, and helping clients understand new tax laws and procedures as well as correspondence received from KRA. Most importantly, I support clients through dispute resolution with KRA, including tax reconciliations, responses to demand letters, and objections to assessments.

Tax Payer Education & Thought Leadership

One of my professional aims is to make tax theory accessible for all. To achieve this, I am a regular contributor of tax articles to various magazines, including ICPAK's "The Accountant" Magazine.

I also run two personal blogs on Substack and LinkedIn (Tax and More), where I share weekly discussions of tax theories.

Skills

Financial Management ● ● ● ● ●

Financial accounting, financial reporting, budget preparation & expenditure tracking, development of models and cash flow planning & forecasting.

Operations Management ● ● ● ● ●

Setting up and improving operational systems.

Performance Management ● ● ● ● ●

Reviewing individual performance and conducting end of year appraisal.

Accounting ● ● ● ● ●

Generally Accepted Accounting Principles (GAAPs), International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS), International Accounting Standards (IAS), International Public Sector Accounting Standards (IPSAS), multi-currency accounting and Audit Procedures.

Leadership ● ● ● ● ●

Led two finance and administration teams concurrently; at **Yakwetu Online Limited** and at **PHAT! Music & Entertainment Limited**

Administrative Management ● ● ● ● ●

Creating administrative policies, lean initiatives & processes.

Risk Assessment ● ● ● ● ●

Business risk appraisal and risk management.

Tax Management ● ● ● ● ●

Tax planning, tax accounting, tax policy advice, tax research and compliance advisory.

ICT Competency ● ● ● ● ●

Accounting software (QuickBooks, SAP, Tally, Zoho), project management software (Airmee, Marcato) and data analysis & presentation tools (Advanced Microsoft Excel, Advanced Microsoft Word, Microsoft PowerPoint, SPSS, STATA, Power BI).

References

Available Upon Request